30 bài mẫu IELTS Writing Task 2 — Arts & Culture

Từ và cụm quan trọng được tô màu; cuối mỗi bài là các cụm cần nhớ kèm nghĩa. Điểm do AI chấm, chỉ để tham khảo.

Cụm từ | Từ đồng nghĩa | Từ nối | Khung câu | Câu mang ý | Câu ví dụ

Agree / Disagree

#35 Agree / Disagree · 305 từ · AI 8.0

Some believe the arts should be funded by government. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Theatres, orchestras and museums often depend on grants, and some believe that the arts should be funded by government. I largely agree, since the market alone would neglect many valuable forms of art, although public money should be spent carefully and without political control.

To begin with, public funding allows the arts to exist where the market alone would neglect them. Commercial success rewards popular entertainment, so experimental theatre, classical music and local museums often need grants to survive and to offer low prices. A small theatre that stages new plays, for example, may never make a profit but enriches the cultural life of a city. Without subsidy, ticket prices would rise beyond the means of many people, and only the richest would enjoy the arts. Public support also protects cultural heritage, such as archives and traditional performances, which have no commercial value but great importance for national identity. Society gains cultural diversity and wider access to the arts.

Furthermore, the arts bring benefits that justify public spending. They attract tourists, create jobs, improve the quality of city life and contribute to education and wellbeing. Studies of many cities suggest that every unit of money spent on culture returns a larger amount in local spending. However, funding should be limited and fair. Money spent on the arts cannot be used for hospitals and schools, so priorities have to be balanced, and governments must not use funds to control content or to support only the art that they approve of. An independent arts council, which allocates grants through open competition, protects artistic freedom. Artists and companies should also be encouraged to earn some income themselves.

In conclusion, the arts should be funded by government to a large extent, because they enrich society and would otherwise suffer, provided that funding is independent and balanced with other needs.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Theatres, orchestras and museums** — nhà hát, dàn nhạc và bảo tàng
- **depend on grants** — phụ thuộc vào khoản trợ cấp
- **funded by government** — được chính phủ tài trợ
- **neglect many valuable forms of art** — bỏ qua nhiều loại hình nghệ thuật có giá trị
- **public money** — tiền công
- **without political control** — không có sự kiểm soát chính trị
- **public funding** — tài trợ công
- **Commercial success rewards popular entertainment** — thành công thương mại thưởng cho giải trí phổ biến
- **experimental theatre, classical music** — kịch thể nghiệm, nhạc cổ điển
- **offer low prices** — đưa ra giá thấp
- **stages new plays** — dàn dựng vở kịch mới
- **never make a profit** — không bao giờ có lãi
- **enriches the cultural life of a city** — làm giàu đời sống văn hoá của thành phố
- **beyond the means of many people** — vượt quá khả năng của nhiều người
- **no commercial value but great importance** — không có giá trị thương mại nhưng rất quan trọng
- **national identity** — bản sắc quốc gia
- **cultural diversity and wider access** — đa dạng văn hoá và tiếp cận rộng hơn
- **attract tourists, create jobs** — thu hút du khách, tạo việc làm
- **returns a larger amount in local spending** — đem lại khoản chi tiêu địa phương lớn hơn
- **limited and fair** — có giới hạn và công bằng
- **control content** — kiểm soát nội dung
- **An independent arts council** — một hội đồng nghệ thuật độc lập
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn

#95 Agree / Disagree · 281 từ · AI 8.0

Some believe that history should be taught from multiple perspectives. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Textbooks that present one national story are increasingly challenged, and some believe that history should be taught from multiple perspectives. I agree to a large extent, since it builds critical thinking and fairness, although a clear framework is needed.

To begin with, teaching history from several perspectives builds critical thinking and fairness. Events look different to winners and losers, rulers and ordinary people, and comparing accounts teaches pupils to weigh evidence and to understand why people disagree. A class that reads accounts of the same battle from both armies, for example, learns that history depends on who is telling it. Students learn to ask who wrote a source, why and for whom, skills that help them to judge news and political claims in later life. They also develop empathy, since they see how events affected different groups of people, including those who are often absent from official histories, such as women, workers and minorities.

Furthermore, a single national story can create pride that blinds people to injustice, and it may leave members of minority groups feeling invisible. Presenting several perspectives gives a fuller and more honest picture, which strengthens democracy. However, too many versions without a clear framework may confuse young pupils, and teachers need to ensure that accounts are supported by evidence rather than presenting all opinions as equally valid. Some basic facts are not open to debate. Curricula should therefore set out core knowledge and chronology and then encourage comparison of interpretations, with age-appropriate material and trained teachers.

In conclusion, history should be taught from multiple perspectives to a large extent, because this develops critical thinking and understanding, provided that it is based on evidence and a clear framework.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **one national story** — một câu chuyện quốc gia
- **taught from multiple perspectives** — được dạy từ nhiều góc nhìn
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **builds critical thinking and fairness** — xây dựng tư duy phản biện và sự công bằng
- **a clear framework** — khung rõ ràng
- **winners and losers, rulers and ordinary people** — người thắng và người thua, người cai trị và dân thường
- **comparing accounts** — so sánh các tường thuật
- **weigh evidence** — cân nhắc bằng chứng
- **understand why people disagree** — hiểu vì sao người ta bất đồng
- **the same battle from both armies** — cùng một trận đánh từ cả hai đạo quân
- **history depends on who is telling it** — lịch sử phụ thuộc vào người kể
- **who wrote a source, why and for whom** — ai viết nguồn tài liệu, vì sao và cho ai
- **judge news and political claims** — đánh giá tin tức và tuyên bố chính trị
- **women, workers and minorities** — phụ nữ, công nhân và người thiểu số
- **pride that blinds people to injustice** — niềm tự hào làm người ta mù trước bất công
- **minority groups** — nhóm thiểu số
- **invisible** — vô hình
- **a fuller and more honest picture** — bức tranh đầy đủ và trung thực hơn
- **strengthens democracy** — củng cố dân chủ
- **equally valid** — đúng như nhau
- **core knowledge and chronology** — kiến thức cốt lõi và niên biểu
- **age-appropriate** — phù hợp lứa tuổi

#107 Agree / Disagree · 299 từ · AI 8.0

Many people say that public art improves cities. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Sculptures in squares, murals on blank walls and installations in parks are increasingly common, and many people say that public art improves cities. I agree with this view, since public art makes shared spaces more attractive and gives a city a distinct character, although it needs to be chosen with care.

To begin with, public art makes shared spaces more attractive and gives a city a distinct character. Sculptures, murals and installations turn ordinary streets into places that people enjoy and remember, and they can lift the mood of a whole neighbourhood. A blank wall that is turned into a colourful mural, for example, can lift the mood of a whole street, and discourage graffiti and neglect. Famous works become landmarks that appear on postcards and attract tourists, which supports local businesses. Art in public places is also free for everyone, including people who would never enter a gallery, so it brings culture to everyday life.

Furthermore, public art can bring communities together and express local identity. Projects in which residents help to design or paint a work give people a sense of ownership and pride, and works can commemorate events or celebrate diversity. However, public art has limits. It costs money, and some residents may feel that it is a waste when schools or roads need funding. Tastes differ, and some works may be disliked or vandalised. Poorly maintained works can make an area look worse. To reduce these problems, cities should consult residents, involve local artists, plan for maintenance and select works that suit their surroundings. When done well, public art repays its cost many times in civic pride.

In conclusion, I agree that public art improves cities, because it creates attractive, distinctive and welcoming spaces, provided that works are chosen with the community and cared for.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Sculptures in squares, murals on blank walls** — tượng ở quảng trường, tranh tường trên bức tường trống
- **installations in parks** — tác phẩm sắp đặt ở công viên
- **public art improves cities** — nghệ thuật công cộng cải thiện thành phố
- **makes shared spaces more attractive** — làm không gian chung hấp dẫn hơn
- **gives a city a distinct character** — cho thành phố một đặc trưng riêng
- **turn ordinary streets into places that people enjoy and remember** — biến phố bình thường thành nơi người ta thích và nhớ
- **lift the mood of a whole neighbourhood** — nâng tinh thần cả khu phố
- **A blank wall** — một bức tường trống
- **a colourful mural** — bức tranh tường nhiều màu
- **discourage graffiti and neglect** — ngăn vẽ bậy và sự bỏ bê
- **become landmarks** — trở thành địa danh
- **postcards and attract tourists** — bưu thiếp và thu hút du khách
- **free for everyone** — miễn phí cho mọi người
- **bring communities together** — gắn kết cộng đồng
- **express local identity** — thể hiện bản sắc địa phương
- **a sense of ownership and pride** — cảm giác sở hữu và tự hào
- **has limits** — có giới hạn
- **vandalised** — bị phá hoại
- **poorly maintained** — bảo trì kém
- **consult residents, involve local artists** — tham vấn cư dân, mời nghệ sĩ địa phương
- **repays its cost many times in civic pride** — hoàn vốn nhiều lần qua niềm tự hào công dân

#121 Agree / Disagree · 260 từ · AI 7.5

Some people say that public celebrations waste resources. Do you agree or disagree?

National days, cultural festivals and anniversary parades are common in almost every country, and some people say that public celebrations waste resources. I disagree with this view, since celebrations bring lasting benefits that usually outweigh their costs, although money should be spent with care.

To begin with, public celebrations cost money and create waste, but they also bring lasting benefits. Fireworks, decorations and security cost large sums and leave litter, yet they strengthen community spirit, attract visitors and mark shared history. A town that spends a large sum on fireworks, for example, may see them last for twenty minutes, but residents remember the evening for years. Celebrations give people a reason to meet neighbours, share food and enjoy music together, and these experiences build the trust and pride that hold communities together. They also give children a sense of belonging and tradition.

Furthermore, celebrations support the local economy. Visitors fill hotels and restaurants, stallholders and performers earn income, and publicity increases a town's reputation. Cultural festivals can promote heritage, music and crafts that might otherwise be forgotten. However, spending should be sensible. Large events should be planned with budgets, sponsorship, ticket income and volunteers, litter should be recycled and noise should be controlled, so that residents are not inconvenienced. Where money is truly short, resources could be directed to the most meaningful celebrations. Simple celebrations, such as community picnics, can be inexpensive and just as enjoyable.

In conclusion, I disagree that public celebrations waste resources, because they bring social and economic benefits, provided that they are carefully planned and managed.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **National days, cultural festivals and anniversary parades** — ngày quốc gia, lễ hội văn hoá và diễu hành kỷ niệm
- **public celebrations waste resources** — lễ kỷ niệm công cộng lãng phí tài nguyên
- **lasting benefits** — lợi ích lâu dài
- **outweigh their costs** — lớn hơn chi phí của chúng
- **cost money and create waste** — tốn tiền và tạo ra rác thải
- **Fireworks, decorations and security cost large sums** — pháo hoa, đồ trang trí và an ninh tốn những khoản lớn
- **leave litter** — để lại rác
- **strengthen community spirit** — củng cố tinh thần cộng đồng
- **mark shared history** — đánh dấu lịch sử chung
- **last for twenty minutes** — kéo dài hai mươi phút
- **remember the evening for years** — nhớ buổi tối đó nhiều năm
- **a reason to meet neighbours** — lý do để gặp hàng xóm
- **share food and enjoy music together** — cùng chia sẻ đồ ăn và thưởng thức âm nhạc
- **build the trust and pride that hold communities together** — xây dựng lòng tin và niềm tự hào gắn kết cộng đồng
- **a sense of belonging and tradition** — cảm giác thuộc về và truyền thống
- **Visitors fill hotels and restaurants** — du khách lấp đầy khách sạn và nhà hàng
- **stallholders and performers earn income** — người bán hàng và nghệ sĩ có thu nhập
- **increases a town's reputation** — tăng danh tiếng của một thị trấn
- **budgets, sponsorship, ticket income and volunteers** — ngân sách, tài trợ, thu vé và tình nguyện viên
- **controlled** — được kiểm soát
- **community picnics** — buổi dã ngoại cộng đồng

#135 Agree / Disagree · 293 từ · AI 7.5

Some believe that museums should be free to visit. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Many national museums charge an entrance fee, while others allow anyone to walk in without paying, and some believe that museums should be free to visit. I largely agree, since free entry makes them open to everyone, although money to run them must be found elsewhere.

To begin with, free entry makes museums open to everyone, not only those who can afford a ticket. Families on low incomes, students and older people visit more often when no fee is charged, schools can bring classes without cost, and the knowledge held in public collections belongs to the public. A family with three children who would never pay for tickets, for example, may visit a free museum every month. In countries such as the United Kingdom, where many national museums are free, visitor numbers are high and include people who rarely attend cultural venues. Museums are educational institutions, and access to them should not depend on income. Free entry also encourages short, repeated visits, which are better for learning than a single expensive trip.

Furthermore, free museums bring wider benefits. They attract tourists who spend money in nearby cafes, hotels and shops, and they improve a city's image. However, free entry has costs. Museums need money for conservation, security, staff and new exhibitions, and if governments reduce funding, quality may suffer. This money can be found through taxes, donations, sponsorship, shops and cafes, or through charges for special exhibitions, while permanent collections remain free. Voluntary donation boxes also allow those who can afford it to contribute. Reduced prices for tourists, who are not taxpayers, are another possibility.

In conclusion, museums should be free to a large extent, because culture and education should be open to all, provided that adequate funding is secured from other sources.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **national museums charge an entrance fee** — các bảo tàng quốc gia thu phí vào cửa
- **free to visit** — miễn phí tham quan
- **open to everyone** — mở cửa cho mọi người
- **afford a ticket** — đủ tiền mua vé
- **Families on low incomes, students and older people** — gia đình thu nhập thấp, sinh viên và người cao tuổi
- **bring classes without cost** — đưa cả lớp đến mà không tốn tiền
- **the knowledge held in public collections belongs to the public** — tri thức trong các bộ sưu tập công thuộc về công chúng
- **rarely attend cultural venues** — hiếm khi đến nơi văn hoá
- **depend on income** — phụ thuộc vào thu nhập
- **short, repeated visits** — những lần thăm ngắn, lặp lại
- **cafes, hotels and shops** — quán cà phê, khách sạn và cửa hàng
- **improve a city's image** — cải thiện hình ảnh của thành phố
- **conservation, security, staff and new exhibitions** — bảo tồn, an ninh, nhân viên và triển lãm mới
- **quality may suffer** — chất lượng có thể bị ảnh hưởng
- **donations, sponsorship, shops and cafes** — quyên góp, tài trợ, cửa hàng và quán cà phê
- **charges for special exhibitions** — phí cho triển lãm đặc biệt
- **permanent collections remain free** — bộ sưu tập thường trực vẫn miễn phí
- **donation boxes** — hộp quyên góp
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **adequate funding is secured from other sources** — có nguồn kinh phí đủ từ những nguồn khác

#184 Agree / Disagree · 291 từ · AI 7.5

Many feel that streaming music has changed the music industry negatively. Do you agree? Explain your view.

Millions of songs are now available to anyone with a phone and a monthly subscription, and many feel that streaming music has changed the music industry negatively. I partly agree, since streaming has made music cheap and easy for listeners but has hurt many artists' incomes.

To begin with, streaming has made music cheap and easy to find for listeners, which is a real benefit. Millions of songs are available for a monthly fee, and new artists can reach a global audience without a record company. A teenager in a small town can discover music from every continent, and unknown musicians can build a following online. Streaming has also reduced piracy, since legal access is convenient and inexpensive. These changes have widened choice and made music more democratic than at any time before.

However, there are negative consequences for artists and for the industry. Each stream pays only a tiny amount, so musicians who are not already famous earn little. A musician whose song is played a million times, for example, may earn only a few thousand pounds, which would not cover the cost of making an album. Songs have become shorter and designed to grab attention in the first seconds, and albums have lost importance as listeners choose individual tracks and playlists. Algorithms may favour already popular artists, and small independent labels struggle to survive. Fairer payment systems, larger shares for artists and more support for live work are needed to keep musicians in business. The result of the present arrangement is that listeners benefit more than creators.

In conclusion, streaming has changed the music industry for the better as far as listeners are concerned but for the worse for many musicians, so I agree only partly with the statement.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a monthly subscription** — gói thuê bao hằng tháng
- **streaming music** — nghe nhạc trực tuyến
- **changed the music industry negatively** — làm thay đổi ngành âm nhạc theo hướng tiêu cực
- **hurt many artists' incomes** — gây hại cho thu nhập của nhiều nghệ sĩ
- **cheap and easy to find** — rẻ và dễ tìm
- **a monthly fee** — phí hằng tháng
- **reach a global audience** — tiếp cận khán giả toàn cầu
- **a record company** — hãng thu âm
- **discover music from every continent** — khám phá âm nhạc từ mọi châu lục
- **build a following online** — xây dựng lượng người theo dõi trực tuyến
- **reduced piracy** — giảm vi phạm bản quyền
- **widened choice** — mở rộng lựa chọn
- **Each stream pays only a tiny amount** — mỗi lượt nghe chỉ trả một khoản rất nhỏ
- **not already famous** — chưa nổi tiếng
- **played a million times** — được phát một triệu lần
- **would not cover the cost of making an album** — không đủ trang trải chi phí làm album
- **grab attention in the first seconds** — gây chú ý trong những giây đầu
- **albums have lost importance** — album mất đi tầm quan trọng
- **Algorithms** — thuật toán
- **small independent labels struggle to survive** — các hãng độc lập nhỏ khó tồn tại
- **Fairer payment systems** — hệ thống trả công công bằng hơn

#227 Agree / Disagree · 305 từ · AI 8.0

Many people say that cultural appropriation is harmful. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

When a global brand sells clothes with patterns copied from a village, or a festival-goer wears a headdress that is sacred to another culture, controversy often follows, and many people say that cultural appropriation is harmful. I partly agree, since appropriation can exploit and offend, although cultural exchange itself is natural and often positive.

To begin with, cultural appropriation is harmful when it exploits or mocks. Companies that profit from sacred symbols without credit or payment, or costumes that reduce a culture to a stereotype, cause offence. A fashion brand that copies a sacred pattern from an indigenous community without permission, for example, profits from a tradition that its owners cannot protect. The original creators may receive no income, while outsiders become famous for work that is not theirs. When sacred objects are used as fashion accessories, it can hurt the people for whom they have deep meaning. In addition, stereotypes can reinforce prejudice, particularly when a group has already suffered discrimination and has little power to defend its traditions.

However, cultural exchange itself is natural. Cultures have always borrowed foods, music, clothing and ideas from one another, and this has produced much of the richness of the modern world. Learning from and honouring another culture, with permission and respect, enriches both sides, and an overly strict view could discourage people from learning about or appreciating other traditions. The difference lies in respect, credit and fair sharing of benefits. A designer who works with artisans from the community, pays them fairly and names them as creators, for example, shows how exchange can benefit everyone. Blanket bans are therefore less useful than clear principles of respect.

In conclusion, cultural appropriation is harmful when it exploits, mocks or ignores the owners of a tradition, but exchange itself is valuable, so I agree only partly with the statement.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **patterns copied from a village** — hoa văn sao chép từ một ngôi làng
- **a headdress that is sacred to another culture** — mũ đội đầu thiêng liêng của một nền văn hoá khác
- **cultural appropriation is harmful** — chiếm dụng văn hoá là có hại
- **exploit and offend** — khai thác và xúc phạm
- **cultural exchange itself is natural** — bản thân trao đổi văn hoá là tự nhiên
- **exploits or mocks** — lợi dụng hoặc chế giễu
- **profit from sacred symbols without credit or payment** — hưởng lợi từ biểu tượng thiêng mà không ghi công hay trả tiền
- **reduce a culture to a stereotype** — rút gọn một nền văn hoá thành khuôn mẫu
- **cause offence** — gây xúc phạm
- **an indigenous community** — một cộng đồng bản địa
- **a tradition that its owners cannot protect** — truyền thống mà chủ sở hữu không thể bảo vệ
- **receive no income** — không nhận được thu nhập
- **fashion accessories** — phụ kiện thời trang
- **reinforce prejudice** — củng cố định kiến
- **little power to defend its traditions** — ít quyền lực để bảo vệ truyền thống của mình
- **borrowed foods, music, clothing and ideas** — vay mượn món ăn, âm nhạc, trang phục và ý tưởng
- **the richness of the modern world** — sự phong phú của thế giới hiện đại
- **with permission and respect** — có phép và tôn trọng
- **respect, credit and fair sharing of benefits** — sự tôn trọng, ghi công và chia sẻ lợi ích công bằng
- **blanket bans** — lệnh cấm hoàn toàn

#235 Agree / Disagree · 288 từ · AI 8.0

Some believe that art is more important than science. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Debates about whether art or science matters more are old, and some believe that art is more important than science. I disagree with this view to a large extent, since both meet essential human needs, and in terms of material survival, science is more important.

To begin with, science meets basic needs on which everything else depends. Science improves health, safety and living standards: vaccines, clean water, agriculture, energy and communications all result from scientific research. Without medicine, many people would die young, and without technology, modern life would be impossible. People who are hungry or ill cannot enjoy art, so material needs have to be met first. In emergencies such as pandemics or natural disasters, society looks to scientists for solutions, not to artists. Scientific method also teaches rational thinking, which protects people from superstition and misinformation.

However, art is also essential in a different way. Art gives meaning, beauty and shared identity and shapes how people understand their lives. Music, literature and painting express emotions, record history and help people through difficult times, and many societies judge their achievements by their culture as much as by their wealth. An engineer who designs a bridge, for example, needs science to make it strong and art to make it beautiful. Art and science also depend on each other, since scientific discoveries are sparked by imagination and artists use new technology. To claim that one is more important than the other is therefore a false choice. A society needs both, though science has the stronger claim when it comes to survival.

In conclusion, I disagree that art is more important than science, because science meets basic needs, although art gives life meaning and the two should be valued together.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **art or science matters more** — nghệ thuật hay khoa học quan trọng hơn
- **art is more important than science** — nghệ thuật quan trọng hơn khoa học
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **essential human needs** — nhu cầu thiết yếu của con người
- **material survival** — sinh tồn vật chất
- **meets basic needs on which everything else depends** — đáp ứng nhu cầu cơ bản mà mọi thứ khác dựa vào
- **improves health, safety and living standards** — cải thiện sức khoẻ, an toàn và mức sống
- **vaccines, clean water, agriculture, energy and communications** — vaccine, nước sạch, nông nghiệp, năng lượng và truyền thông
- **scientific research** — nghiên cứu khoa học
- **die young** — chết trẻ
- **hungry or ill** — đói hoặc ốm
- **material needs have to be met first** — nhu cầu vật chất phải được đáp ứng trước
- **pandemics or natural disasters** — đại dịch hoặc thiên tai
- **rational thinking** — tư duy lý trí
- **superstition and misinformation** — mê tín và thông tin sai lệch
- **meaning, beauty and shared identity** — ý nghĩa, vẻ đẹp và bản sắc chung
- **express emotions, record history** — bày tỏ cảm xúc, ghi lại lịch sử
- **help people through difficult times** — giúp mọi người vượt qua thời kỳ khó khăn
- **designs a bridge** — thiết kế một cây cầu
- **sparked by imagination** — được khơi dậy bởi trí tưởng tượng
- **a false choice** — một sự lựa chọn sai
- **the stronger claim** — lập luận mạnh hơn

#286 Agree / Disagree · 290 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent do you agree or disagree that reading fiction improves empathy?

Millions of people read novels, and many say that reading fiction improves empathy. I largely agree, since fiction lets readers live inside other minds, although the effect depends on how readers engage with stories.

To begin with, reading fiction lets people live inside other minds and so strengthens empathy. Novels invite readers to share the thoughts and feelings of characters from different backgrounds, which trains the habit of seeing situations from another point of view. A reader who follows a refugee's journey in a novel, for example, may understand fear and hope in a way that a news report does not convey. Unlike films, books describe thoughts and emotions in detail, so readers have to imagine and interpret, which exercises the mental skills that empathy needs. Some studies have found that readers of literary fiction score higher on tests of understanding other people's feelings, although the evidence is not always consistent.

Furthermore, fiction offers safe experiences of situations that readers may never face. Through stories they can feel what it is like to be poor, ill, powerful or an outsider, and to see how the same event looks different to different people. This may reduce prejudice and encourage kindness. However, reading does not automatically make people more empathetic. Some readers read only to be entertained, or identify only with characters who resemble themselves, and empathy ultimately depends on action as well as imagination. Reading non-fiction, travelling and meeting different people also build understanding, so fiction is only one route. Fiction is most powerful when readers discuss it and think about its characters' choices.

In conclusion, I largely agree that reading fiction improves empathy, because it trains readers to understand other people's perspectives, though its effect varies from person to person.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Millions of people read novels** — hàng triệu người đọc tiểu thuyết
- **reading fiction improves empathy** — đọc tiểu thuyết cải thiện sự đồng cảm
- **live inside other minds** — sống trong tâm trí người khác
- **share the thoughts and feelings of characters** — chia sẻ suy nghĩ và cảm xúc của nhân vật
- **from different backgrounds** — từ các xuất thân khác nhau
- **seeing situations from another point of view** — nhìn tình huống từ góc nhìn khác
- **follows a refugee's journey** — theo dõi hành trình của một người tị nạn
- **fear and hope** — nỗi sợ và hy vọng
- **a news report does not convey** — bản tin không truyền đạt được
- **describe thoughts and emotions in detail** — mô tả chi tiết suy nghĩ và cảm xúc
- **imagine and interpret** — tưởng tượng và diễn giải
- **the mental skills that empathy needs** — kỹ năng tinh thần mà sự đồng cảm cần
- **understanding other people's feelings** — hiểu cảm xúc của người khác
- **not always consistent** — không phải lúc nào cũng nhất quán
- **safe experiences of situations that readers may never face** — trải nghiệm an toàn về những tình huống người đọc có thể không bao giờ gặp
- **poor, ill, powerful or an outsider** — nghèo, ốm, có quyền lực hoặc là người ngoài cuộc
- **reduce prejudice** — giảm định kiến
- **automatically** — một cách tự động
- **only to be entertained** — chỉ để giải trí
- **imagination** — trí tưởng tượng
- **varies from person to person** — khác nhau tuỳ từng người

#309 Agree / Disagree · 305 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that art galleries are elitist. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Marble halls, silent rooms and unfamiliar vocabulary can make an art gallery feel like a place for specialists, and many people say that galleries are elitist. I disagree with this view to a large extent, since galleries can feel exclusive but many are working hard to open their doors.

To begin with, galleries can feel exclusive, but that is largely a matter of habit and perception. High prices, specialist language and an intimidating atmosphere can discourage newcomers, and some people believe that they do not know enough about art to enjoy it. Surveys show that visitors tend to be more educated and wealthy than the population as a whole. Yet this does not mean that galleries are designed to exclude anyone. A first-time visitor who joins a free guided tour, for example, may find that a gallery is much friendlier than she expected. The problem is largely one of habit and confidence, which can be changed, not a rule of the institution.

Furthermore, many galleries are free, offer family days, workshops, tours and talks, and show art that reflects a wide range of communities. Digital collections allow anyone to explore artworks online from home, and community projects take exhibitions into schools, libraries and shopping centres. Younger curators try to explain works in plain language. Admittedly, some private galleries remain expensive and sell works only to wealthy collectors, and the art market as a whole is dominated by large sums of money. However, public galleries exist to serve everyone, and when they are free and welcoming, they are among the most open of cultural institutions. Elitism is therefore not inherent in art, but in attitudes that can be changed.

In conclusion, I disagree that galleries are elitist, because most make real efforts to include everyone, although they should continue to lower barriers and reach new audiences.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Marble halls, silent rooms and unfamiliar vocabulary** — sảnh cẩm thạch, phòng im lặng và từ ngữ lạ lẫm
- **a place for specialists** — nơi dành cho chuyên gia
- **galleries are elitist** — phòng tranh mang tính tinh hoa
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **feel exclusive** — cảm thấy mang tính loại trừ
- **habit and perception** — thói quen và nhận thức
- **High prices, specialist language and an intimidating atmosphere** — giá cao, ngôn ngữ chuyên môn và bầu không khí đáng sợ
- **discourage newcomers** — làm nản người mới
- **more educated and wealthy than the population as a whole** — học vấn cao và giàu hơn toàn bộ dân số
- **designed to exclude anyone** — được thiết kế để loại trừ ai đó
- **a free guided tour** — tour có hướng dẫn miễn phí
- **much friendlier than she expected** — thân thiện hơn nhiều so với cô mong đợi
- **family days, workshops, tours and talks** — ngày gia đình, hội thảo, tour và buổi nói chuyện
- **reflects a wide range of communities** — phản ánh nhiều cộng đồng
- **Digital collections** — bộ sưu tập số
- **explore artworks online from home** — khám phá tác phẩm trực tuyến tại nhà
- **libraries and shopping centres** — thư viện và trung tâm mua sắm
- **plain language** — ngôn ngữ đơn giản
- **sell works only to wealthy collectors** — chỉ bán tác phẩm cho nhà sưu tầm giàu
- **serve everyone** — phục vụ mọi người
- **lower barriers and reach new audiences** — hạ rào cản và tiếp cận khán giả mới

#317 Agree / Disagree · 289 từ · AI 8.0

Some believe that museums should focus on local history. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Some museums tell the story of a whole civilisation, while others concentrate on a town, a trade or a family, and some believe that museums should focus on local history. I agree only to a limited extent, since local history gives museums relevance, but a purely local focus can narrow understanding.

To begin with, local history gives museums relevance and a sense of community. People connect strongly with stories about their own town, family and neighbours, and local collections are often neglected elsewhere. A museum about the town's old textile mill, for example, helps residents to understand where their grandparents worked. Local museums can preserve everyday objects, photographs and oral histories that national institutions would never collect, and they can involve residents as donors, volunteers and storytellers. This builds pride and belonging, and it attracts visitors who want to see a place from the inside. Children are often more interested in history that happened where they live.

However, a purely local focus can narrow understanding. Local events are part of national and world history, and visitors need to see how the textile mill, for instance, connected to global trade, migration and technology. Large museums also have the resources to display collections from across the world, which allow people to learn about other cultures and periods. A museum that shows only its own area risks becoming inward-looking and uninteresting to visitors from elsewhere. A balance is best: local museums should explain their area within a wider context, and national museums should include local stories, so that visitors can see how the particular and the general connect.

In conclusion, museums should focus on local history only to a limited extent, because relevance is valuable but a wider perspective is also essential.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **tell the story of a whole civilisation** — kể câu chuyện của cả một nền văn minh
- **a town, a trade or a family** — một thị trấn, một nghề hoặc một gia đình
- **museums should focus on local history** — bảo tàng nên tập trung vào lịch sử địa phương
- **to a limited extent** — ở mức độ hạn chế
- **narrow understanding** — làm hẹp sự hiểu biết
- **relevance and a sense of community** — sự liên quan và cảm giác cộng đồng
- **connect strongly with stories about their own town** — gắn bó mạnh với câu chuyện về thị trấn của mình
- **neglected elsewhere** — bị bỏ quên ở nơi khác
- **the town's old textile mill** — nhà máy dệt cũ của thị trấn
- **where their grandparents worked** — nơi ông bà họ từng làm việc
- **everyday objects, photographs and oral histories** — đồ vật hằng ngày, ảnh và lịch sử truyền miệng
- **donors, volunteers and storytellers** — người tặng, tình nguyện viên và người kể chuyện
- **builds pride and belonging** — xây dựng niềm tự hào và cảm giác thuộc về
- **see a place from the inside** — nhìn một nơi từ bên trong
- **global trade, migration and technology** — thương mại toàn cầu, di cư và công nghệ
- **collections from across the world** — bộ sưu tập từ khắp thế giới
- **learn about other cultures and periods** — tìm hiểu các nền văn hoá và thời kỳ khác
- **inward-looking** — hướng nội
- **within a wider context** — trong bối cảnh rộng hơn
- **the particular and the general** — cái riêng và cái chung
- **a wider perspective** — góc nhìn rộng hơn

#343 Agree / Disagree · 295 từ · AI 8.0

Some people say that museums should charge for entry to fund operations. Do you agree or disagree?

Running a museum is expensive, and some people say that museums should charge for entry to fund operations. I disagree with this view, since charging excludes people and raises only a small part of the cost, although fees for special exhibitions can be reasonable.

To begin with, charging for entry raises money but excludes people and may reduce visitor numbers. Fees can pay for conservation and staff, yet they discourage low-income visitors, and museums have other sources of income such as grants, sponsors, shops and charges for special exhibitions. A student who cannot afford a twenty-pound ticket, for example, may never see a collection that is meant to belong to everyone. When some national museums in several countries introduced entry fees, attendance fell sharply, and when they dropped them, numbers recovered. Because visitors fall, income from shops and cafes also decreases, so the net gain from tickets is often small. Museums exist to educate the public, and an entry fee works against that aim.

Furthermore, there are better ways to fund museums. Governments can pay for them because they provide education and tourism benefits, private sponsors and donors gain recognition for supporting culture, and museum shops, cafes and event hire generate income without affecting access. Memberships and voluntary donations allow those who can afford to support the museum to do so. However, some charging may be reasonable. Special exhibitions with high costs can have a ticket price, and tourists, who do not pay local taxes, could be asked for a fee, while local residents and children enter free. Such mixed models share the cost fairly.

In conclusion, I disagree that museums should charge for entry to fund their operations, because it excludes people and brings limited benefits, although charges for special exhibitions can be sensible.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Running a museum is expensive** — vận hành một bảo tàng rất tốn kém
- **charge for entry to fund operations** — thu phí vào cửa để tài trợ hoạt động
- **raises only a small part of the cost** — chỉ đáp ứng một phần nhỏ chi phí
- **raises money but excludes people** — thu được tiền nhưng loại trừ người ta
- **reduce visitor numbers** — làm giảm số lượng khách
- **pay for conservation and staff** — trả cho việc bảo tồn và nhân viên
- **discourage low-income visitors** — làm nản khách thu nhập thấp
- **grants, sponsors, shops** — trợ cấp, nhà tài trợ, cửa hàng
- **charges for special exhibitions** — phí cho triển lãm đặc biệt
- **a collection that is meant to belong to everyone** — bộ sưu tập vốn thuộc về mọi người
- **entry fees** — phí vào cửa
- **attendance fell sharply** — lượng khách giảm mạnh
- **numbers recovered** — số lượng phục hồi
- **the net gain from tickets is often small** — khoản lãi ròng từ vé thường nhỏ
- **educate the public** — giáo dục công chúng
- **works against that aim** — đi ngược mục đích đó
- **private sponsors and donors** — nhà tài trợ và người quyên góp tư nhân
- **event hire** — cho thuê tổ chức sự kiện
- **Memberships and voluntary donations** — hội viên và quyên góp tự nguyện
- **a ticket price** — giá vé
- **share the cost fairly** — chia sẻ chi phí công bằng

#409 Agree / Disagree · 297 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that bilingual signs in public places are helpful. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

In airports, railway stations and city streets, signs increasingly appear in two languages, and many people say that bilingual signs in public places are helpful. I agree with this view, since they help visitors and residents to find their way and feel respected, although they have costs.

To begin with, bilingual signs help visitors and residents to find their way and feel respected. Tourists, newcomers and speakers of minority languages can understand directions, warnings and services, which improves safety and access. A railway station with signs in two languages, for example, helps a traveller to find the right platform without asking for help. In an emergency, clear information in a familiar language can prevent confusion and save lives. For migrants who are learning the local language, bilingual signs make daily life easier and reduce stress. Tourists, who contribute to the economy, are more likely to visit places where they feel welcome and can move around independently.

Furthermore, bilingual signs show respect for minority languages and cultures. In regions where two languages are spoken, they treat both communities as equal and help to preserve the weaker language, which strengthens social harmony. However, there are disadvantages. Extra text costs money and can clutter signs, making them harder to read, particularly for drivers who must take in information quickly. Which languages to include can also be a source of dispute. These problems can be reduced by good design, such as using internationally recognised symbols, clear fonts and a limited amount of text, and by choosing languages according to the needs of the local population and visitors. The benefits of inclusion generally outweigh the extra cost.

In conclusion, I agree that bilingual signs in public places are helpful, because they improve access, safety and respect, provided that they are clearly designed.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Airports, railway stations and city streets** — sân bay, nhà ga và đường phố
- **bilingual signs** — biển báo song ngữ
- **find their way** — tìm đường
- **feel respected** — cảm thấy được tôn trọng
- **Tourists, newcomers and speakers of minority languages** — du khách, người mới đến và người nói ngôn ngữ thiểu số
- **directions, warnings and services** — chỉ dẫn, cảnh báo và dịch vụ
- **improves safety and access** — cải thiện an toàn và khả năng tiếp cận
- **the right platform** — đúng sân ga
- **without asking for help** — không cần hỏi giúp
- **prevent confusion and save lives** — ngăn nhầm lẫn và cứu mạng
- **learning the local language** — đang học ngôn ngữ địa phương
- **reduce stress** — giảm căng thẳng
- **move around independently** — di chuyển một cách độc lập
- **show respect for minority languages and cultures** — thể hiện sự tôn trọng ngôn ngữ và văn hoá thiểu số
- **treat both communities as equal** — đối xử cả hai cộng đồng ngang nhau
- **preserve the weaker language** — bảo tồn ngôn ngữ yếu hơn
- **social harmony** — sự hoà hợp xã hội
- **Extra text costs money and can clutter signs** — chữ thêm tốn tiền và có thể làm biển rối mắt
- **internationally recognised symbols** — biểu tượng được quốc tế công nhận
- **inclusion** — sự hoà nhập
- **outweigh the extra cost** — lớn hơn chi phí thêm

#436 Agree / Disagree · 306 từ · AI 8.0

Many people think that public monuments should remain even if controversial. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

Statues of generals, kings and traders stand in many city squares, and some of them are now seen as symbols of slavery, conquest or oppression, so many people think that public monuments should remain even if controversial. I agree to a large extent, since removing them can hide uncomfortable parts of the past, although some cases need special treatment.

To begin with, controversial monuments can be kept if their history is explained. Removing them can hide uncomfortable parts of the past, whereas plaques, museums and discussion help people to learn. A statue of a controversial figure that carries a plaque explaining his crimes, for example, teaches visitors more than an empty plinth. History is not always comfortable, and a society that erases every symbol that offends someone risks forgetting what happened and why. Monuments also show how attitudes have changed, since they reflect the values of the time in which they were built, and keeping them with context allows people to see how far society has moved. Public debate about them can itself be educational.

However, some monuments honour people responsible for great harm, and for communities that suffered, they can cause real pain. Decisions should therefore involve the affected community and clear criteria. In extreme cases, such as monuments that glorify genocide or mass violence, relocation to a museum may be justified, where they can be explained and studied instead of celebrated in a place of honour. Another option is to add new monuments that tell the stories of those who were ignored, so that the public landscape becomes more balanced. Destruction by crowds should be avoided, since decisions should be made lawfully and with debate.

In conclusion, public monuments should generally remain, even if controversial, provided that they are explained, and only in exceptional cases should they be moved, after open and fair discussion.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Statues of generals, kings and traders** — tượng tướng quân, vua và thương nhân
- **symbols of slavery, conquest or oppression** — biểu tượng của nô lệ, chinh phục hoặc áp bức
- **public monuments should remain** — đài tưởng niệm công cộng nên được giữ lại
- **controversial** — gây tranh cãi
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **hide uncomfortable parts of the past** — che giấu những phần khó chịu của quá khứ
- **plaques, museums and discussion** — bảng giải thích, bảo tàng và thảo luận
- **a plaque explaining his crimes** — tấm bảng giải thích tội ác của ông ta
- **an empty plinth** — bệ trống
- **erases every symbol that offends someone** — xoá mọi biểu tượng làm ai đó phật lòng
- **forgetting what happened and why** — quên điều đã xảy ra và vì sao
- **reflect the values of the time in which they were built** — phản ánh giá trị của thời kỳ chúng được xây
- **how far society has moved** — xã hội đã tiến xa đến đâu
- **honour people responsible for great harm** — tôn vinh người chịu trách nhiệm cho tổn hại lớn
- **real pain** — nỗi đau thực sự
- **the affected community and clear criteria** — cộng đồng bị ảnh hưởng và tiêu chí rõ ràng
- **glorify genocide or mass violence** — tôn vinh diệt chủng hoặc bạo lực hàng loạt
- **relocation to a museum** — chuyển vào bảo tàng
- **a place of honour** — nơi trang trọng
- **the stories of those who were ignored** — câu chuyện của những người bị bỏ qua
- **decisions should be made lawfully** — quyết định nên được đưa ra hợp pháp

#469 Agree / Disagree · 282 từ · AI 8.0

Many people say that listening to music helps concentration. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Many people work or study with headphones on, and some say that listening to music helps concentration. I largely agree, although the benefit depends on the task and the type of music.

To begin with, music can help concentration on simple or repetitive tasks. Calm, familiar music blocks out noise and improves mood, which helps with routine work. A student who listens to quiet instrumental music while tidying notes, for example, may work faster and more happily, and many people report that music helps them to exercise, clean or draw. Music can also reduce stress and boredom, so people stay with a task for longer. In an open-plan office or a noisy home, a steady background of sound can mask distracting conversations and make it easier to focus. Studies suggest that people who enjoy their music perform better on certain tasks than those who work in silence.

However, music is not helpful for everything. Songs with lyrics compete with reading and writing, since the brain processes words in both, and the same student may find lyrics distracting during an essay. Unfamiliar, fast or loud music can draw attention away from demanding tasks such as learning new material or solving complex problems. People also differ: some find silence essential, while others cannot work without sound. The best approach is for each person to experiment, choosing instrumental or ambient music for demanding work and saving favourite songs for repetitive tasks or breaks. Volume should be kept low, since loud music can harm hearing as well as concentration.

In conclusion, I largely agree that listening to music helps concentration, particularly for simple tasks, but the effect depends on the task, the music and the individual.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **with headphones on** — đeo tai nghe
- **listening to music helps concentration** — nghe nhạc giúp tập trung
- **simple or repetitive tasks** — việc đơn giản hoặc lặp lại
- **Calm, familiar music blocks out noise** — nhạc êm, quen thuộc chặn tiếng ồn
- **improves mood** — cải thiện tâm trạng
- **routine work** — công việc thường ngày
- **quiet instrumental music** — nhạc không lời nhẹ nhàng
- **tidying notes** — sắp xếp ghi chép
- **reduce stress and boredom** — giảm căng thẳng và chán nản
- **stay with a task for longer** — gắn bó với một việc lâu hơn
- **an open-plan office** — văn phòng không gian mở
- **a steady background of sound** — âm thanh nền ổn định
- **mask distracting conversations** — che những cuộc trò chuyện gây xao nhãng
- **Songs with lyrics compete with reading and writing** — bài hát có lời cạnh tranh với việc đọc và viết
- **the brain processes words** — bộ não xử lý từ ngữ
- **draw attention away from demanding tasks** — kéo sự chú ý khỏi những việc đòi hỏi cao
- **solving complex problems** — giải quyết vấn đề phức tạp
- **experiment** — thử nghiệm
- **ambient music** — nhạc nền êm dịu
- **harm hearing** — gây hại thính giác

#477 Agree / Disagree · 310 từ · AI 8.0

Some believe that national museums should display artifacts from other countries. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Museums in London, Paris and Berlin hold statues, jewellery and manuscripts from all over the world, and some believe that national museums should display artefacts from other countries. I agree to a large extent, since it widens understanding between cultures, although the way in which objects were acquired matters.

To begin with, displaying artefacts from other countries widens understanding and gives access to those who could never travel. National museums let visitors compare cultures and see objects that they would otherwise never be able to see, and a child in a small town can learn about ancient Egypt or China without leaving the country. Seeing the achievements of other peoples helps to challenge stereotypes and builds respect, and well-resourced museums can protect fragile objects with expert care. Such collections encourage scholars from different countries to study objects side by side and to share knowledge. Many museums also invite experts from the countries of origin to help with interpretation.

However, how objects were acquired matters. Many items were taken during colonial rule or without consent, so countries of origin ask for their return and see their display as a continuing injustice. A statue removed from a temple without permission, for example, may be returned or shared on loan after discussions between the museum and the country of origin. Items that were acquired legitimately, through purchase or gift, can remain on show, while those that were stolen or looted should be returned, or shared through long-term loans and digital access. Museums should also be open about the history of their collections and work in partnership with source communities. This approach allows people everywhere to enjoy shared heritage while respecting the rights of its owners.

In conclusion, national museums should display artefacts from other countries to a large extent, provided that they were acquired fairly and that disputed items are returned or shared.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **statues, jewellery and manuscripts from all over the world** — tượng, trang sức và bản thảo từ khắp thế giới
- **display artefacts from other countries** — trưng bày hiện vật từ nước khác
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **widens understanding between cultures** — mở rộng sự hiểu biết giữa các nền văn hoá
- **could never travel** — không bao giờ có thể đi tới
- **compare cultures** — so sánh các nền văn hoá
- **ancient Egypt or China** — Ai Cập hoặc Trung Quốc cổ đại
- **challenge stereotypes** — thách thức định kiến
- **protect fragile objects with expert care** — bảo vệ đồ vật mong manh bằng sự chăm sóc chuyên môn
- **study objects side by side** — nghiên cứu hiện vật cạnh nhau
- **countries of origin** — nước nguồn gốc
- **how objects were acquired** — cách các đồ vật được có được
- **taken during colonial rule** — bị lấy dưới thời thuộc địa
- **without consent** — không có sự đồng ý
- **a continuing injustice** — sự bất công kéo dài
- **removed from a temple without permission** — bị lấy khỏi ngôi đền khi không có phép
- **shared on loan** — được cho mượn chung
- **acquired legitimately** — có được một cách hợp pháp
- **stolen or looted** — bị trộm hoặc cướp bóc
- **long-term loans and digital access** — cho mượn dài hạn và truy cập số
- **source communities** — cộng đồng nguồn gốc

Advantages / Disadvantages

#57 Advantages / Disadvantages · 280 từ · AI 7.5

What are the benefits for a country that focuses on cultural preservation? Use examples.

Historic towns, ancient languages and traditional music are disappearing in many places, and some countries put considerable effort into protecting them. This essay will outline two principal benefits for a country that focuses on cultural preservation: economic gains and a stronger sense of identity.

First and foremost, cultural preservation brings economic benefits. Historic sites, festivals and traditions attract visitors who spend money on hotels, restaurants and souvenirs, and tourism based on heritage creates jobs for guides, craftspeople and hospitality workers. A well-preserved old town, for example, can draw visitors from around the world and support hundreds of local jobs. Heritage also gives communities a reason to maintain buildings and skills that might otherwise be lost, and it supports industries such as traditional crafts, local food and film locations. Italy, Egypt and Cambodia are examples of countries where cultural heritage is a major source of income.

In addition, cultural preservation strengthens identity, education and social cohesion. Historic sites, languages and traditions teach new generations about their roots and give communities a shared sense of belonging, which can help to bring together people of different backgrounds. Schools can use museums and monuments to bring history alive, and young people who understand their heritage are more likely to respect it. Preservation also protects knowledge that cannot be replaced, such as languages or craft techniques that, once lost, cannot be recreated. Although conservation can be expensive and may conflict with development, careful planning can protect the past while allowing the future to be built.

To sum up, cultural preservation brings clear benefits to a country, above all income from tourism and a stronger sense of identity. For these reasons, it deserves sustained public support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Historic towns, ancient languages and traditional music** — thị trấn lịch sử, ngôn ngữ cổ và âm nhạc truyền thống
- **cultural preservation** — bảo tồn văn hoá
- **economic gains and a stronger sense of identity** — lợi ích kinh tế và ý thức bản sắc mạnh hơn
- **Historic sites, festivals and traditions attract visitors** — di tích, lễ hội và truyền thống thu hút du khách
- **hotels, restaurants and souvenirs** — khách sạn, nhà hàng và quà lưu niệm
- **tourism based on heritage** — du lịch dựa trên di sản
- **guides, craftspeople and hospitality workers** — hướng dẫn viên, thợ thủ công và nhân viên khách sạn nhà hàng
- **a well-preserved old town** — một khu phố cổ được bảo tồn tốt
- **support hundreds of local jobs** — nuôi sống hàng trăm việc làm địa phương
- **buildings and skills that might otherwise be lost** — toà nhà và kỹ năng có thể bị mất
- **traditional crafts, local food and film locations** — thủ công truyền thống, ẩm thực địa phương và địa điểm quay phim
- **a major source of income** — nguồn thu nhập chính
- **social cohesion** — sự gắn kết xã hội
- **teach new generations about their roots** — dạy thế hệ mới về cội nguồn
- **a shared sense of belonging** — cảm giác thuộc về chung
- **different backgrounds** — xuất thân khác nhau
- **bring history alive** — làm lịch sử sống động
- **respect it** — tôn trọng nó
- **cannot be replaced** — không thể thay thế
- **cannot be recreated** — không thể tái tạo
- **conservation** — bảo tồn
- **conflict with development** — xung đột với phát triển
- **careful planning** — lập kế hoạch cẩn thận
- **protect the past while allowing the future to be built** — bảo vệ quá khứ trong khi vẫn cho xây dựng tương lai
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng
- **sustained public support** — sự hỗ trợ công lâu dài

Extent

#60 Extent · 310 từ · AI 8.0

To what extent should arts and music be compulsory in schools? Give reasons for your answer.

In many schools, art and music lessons are the first to be cut when timetables are crowded, and some argue that they should be compulsory. I largely agree, since arts and music education develop creativity and confidence in every child, although the amount of compulsory time should be reasonable.

To begin with, arts and music education develops creativity, discipline and confidence in every child. Learning an instrument or practising drawing trains concentration and patience, gives children a way to express feelings and may reveal talents that would otherwise remain hidden. A shy pupil who joins the school choir, for example, may discover a talent and gain confidence that she would never have found in maths class. Research suggests that musical training is linked with better memory and language skills, and group performances teach teamwork and perseverance. Making these subjects compulsory also ensures access for pupils whose families cannot pay for private lessons or equipment, so that opportunities do not depend on income.

Furthermore, the arts prepare young people for working life and for life as citizens. Employers value creativity, communication and the ability to work with others, and cultural experiences help young people to understand different perspectives. However, compulsion has costs. The time required may reduce time for core subjects, and pupils who dislike a particular art form may feel forced. A sensible compromise would require a modest number of hours of arts and music each week, within which pupils can choose between drawing, drama, singing or instruments, while schools ensure that teaching is of good quality. Provided that lessons are enjoyable and well taught, compulsion can introduce many children to something they will value for life.

In conclusion, arts and music should be compulsory in schools to a large extent, because they develop creativity and give all pupils access, provided that the time is reasonable and choice is offered.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **art and music lessons** — tiết nghệ thuật và âm nhạc
- **timetables are crowded** — thời khoá biểu chật
- **develops creativity, discipline and confidence** — phát triển sáng tạo, kỷ luật và sự tự tin
- **trains concentration and patience** — rèn luyện sự tập trung và kiên nhẫn
- **a way to express feelings** — cách để bày tỏ cảm xúc
- **reveal talents that would otherwise remain hidden** — phát hiện tài năng lẽ ra vẫn bị che giấu
- **joins the school choir** — tham gia dàn hợp xướng của trường
- **discover a talent** — phát hiện một tài năng
- **musical training** — đào tạo âm nhạc
- **better memory and language skills** — trí nhớ và kỹ năng ngôn ngữ tốt hơn
- **teamwork and perseverance** — làm việc nhóm và kiên trì
- **ensures access** — đảm bảo sự tiếp cận
- **private lessons or equipment** — bài học riêng hoặc thiết bị
- **depend on income** — phụ thuộc vào thu nhập
- **creativity, communication and the ability to work with others** — sáng tạo, giao tiếp và khả năng làm việc với người khác
- **understand different perspectives** — hiểu các góc nhìn khác nhau
- **compulsion** — sự bắt buộc
- **time for core subjects** — thời gian cho các môn cốt lõi
- **feel forced** — cảm thấy bị ép
- **a sensible compromise** — sự thoả hiệp hợp lý
- **something they will value for life** — điều họ sẽ trân trọng suốt đời
- **compulsory in schools** — bắt buộc ở trường
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn

#322 Extent · 296 từ · AI 8.0

To what extent should governments subsidize cultural industries? Give reasons for your answer.

Films, books, music, theatre and design employ millions of people and shape national identity, and the question is how far governments should subsidise cultural industries. I believe that they should do so to a considerable extent, since subsidies can protect valuable local culture, although support must be targeted and time-limited where possible.

To begin with, subsidies can protect cultural industries from global competition. Small film, publishing and music sectors cannot match the budgets of international giants, and support lets local stories and languages survive while creating jobs and exports. A small country that funds its own films, for example, can tell stories in its own language that foreign studios would never produce. Without support, audiences might see little of their own culture, and young artists might leave to work abroad. Subsidies for training, festivals and translation also open international markets to local creators, so that cultural products become a source of pride and income.

Furthermore, cultural industries bring wider benefits. They create jobs, attract tourists, improve the image of a country and contribute to education and social cohesion. Some cultural activity, such as poetry, folk music or minority-language publishing, will never be commercially profitable, yet it has great value for society. However, too much aid can reduce efficiency. Producers who rely on guaranteed funding may take few risks or make work that appeals to officials instead of audiences, and taxpayers may question paying for entertainment that others enjoy. Support should therefore be competitive, transparent and linked to results, with some projects expected to earn part of their income. Money should be especially available for those that would otherwise disappear.

In conclusion, governments should subsidise cultural industries to a large extent, because they protect diversity and create wider benefits, provided that the support is targeted and accountable.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Films, books, music, theatre and design** — phim, sách, âm nhạc, sân khấu và thiết kế
- **shape national identity** — định hình bản sắc quốc gia
- **subsidise cultural industries** — trợ cấp các ngành công nghiệp văn hoá
- **to a considerable extent** — ở mức độ đáng kể
- **targeted and time-limited** — nhắm mục tiêu và có thời hạn
- **protect cultural industries from global competition** — bảo vệ ngành công nghiệp văn hoá khỏi cạnh tranh toàn cầu
- **match the budgets of international giants** — sánh được ngân sách của các tập đoàn quốc tế
- **jobs and exports** — việc làm và xuất khẩu
- **funds its own films** — tài trợ cho phim của chính mình
- **foreign studios would never produce** — xưởng phim nước ngoài sẽ không bao giờ sản xuất
- **leave to work abroad** — ra nước ngoài làm việc
- **open international markets** — mở thị trường quốc tế
- **a source of pride and income** — nguồn tự hào và thu nhập
- **social cohesion** — sự gắn kết xã hội
- **commercially profitable** — có lãi về mặt thương mại
- **reduce efficiency** — làm giảm hiệu quả
- **appeals to officials instead of audiences** — hấp dẫn quan chức thay vì khán giả
- **competitive, transparent and linked to results** — cạnh tranh, minh bạch và gắn với kết quả
- **disappear** — biến mất
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn

Opinion

#163 Opinion · 296 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the role of fashion in shaping cultural identity.

A kimono, a sari, a kilt and a pair of jeans all say something about the people who wear them, and fashion is often seen as a mirror of culture. This essay will explain two key roles that fashion plays in shaping cultural identity: expressing heritage and belonging, and allowing individuals and groups to define themselves.

First and foremost, clothing communicates who people are and where they belong. Traditional dress expresses national and regional heritage, and wearing it at festivals, weddings and ceremonies keeps customs visible. A young woman who wears her grandmother's traditional dress to a festival, for example, shows pride in her heritage and starts conversations about its meaning. Particular fabrics, colours and patterns may carry religious or historical significance, and national costumes help people to recognise each other abroad. Clothing also marks belonging to groups such as schools, professions or communities, which reinforces shared identity.

In addition, fashion allows people to express personal and group identity. Individuals choose clothes to show their taste, values and mood, and youth movements from punk to hip-hop have used style to signal who they are and what they believe. Fashion also changes as cultures meet, creating new hybrid styles that reflect modern, mixed identities. However, global brands push everyone towards similar looks, and commercial pressure can turn traditional dress into costume or simply a product. Some people feel pressure to conform to the standards of beauty set by advertising. Fashion therefore both reflects and shapes cultural identity, and communities need to value their own dress while remaining open to new influences.

To sum up, fashion plays an important role in shaping cultural identity by showing heritage and by allowing people to define themselves. For these reasons, it deserves to be taken seriously as a form of culture.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **A kimono, a sari, a kilt and a pair of jeans** — kimono, sari, váy kilt và quần jean
- **a mirror of culture** — tấm gương của văn hoá
- **shaping cultural identity** — định hình bản sắc văn hoá
- **expressing heritage and belonging** — thể hiện di sản và sự thuộc về
- **define themselves** — tự định nghĩa mình
- **communicates who people are and where they belong** — truyền đạt người ta là ai và thuộc về đâu
- **Traditional dress** — trang phục truyền thống
- **national and regional heritage** — di sản quốc gia và vùng miền
- **keeps customs visible** — giữ cho phong tục hiện hữu
- **her grandmother's traditional dress** — áo truyền thống của bà cô
- **shows pride in her heritage** — thể hiện niềm tự hào về di sản
- **starts conversations about its meaning** — khơi mào cuộc trò chuyện về ý nghĩa của nó
- **religious or historical significance** — ý nghĩa tôn giáo hoặc lịch sử
- **belonging to groups** — thuộc về các nhóm
- **express personal and group identity** — thể hiện bản sắc cá nhân và nhóm
- **taste, values and mood** — gu thẩm mỹ, giá trị và tâm trạng
- **youth movements from punk to hip-hop** — phong trào thanh niên từ punk đến hip-hop
- **new hybrid styles** — phong cách lai mới
- **push everyone towards similar looks** — đẩy mọi người về diện mạo giống nhau
- **turn traditional dress into costume** — biến trang phục truyền thống thành đồ hoá trang
- **cultural identity** — bản sắc văn hoá
- **taken seriously** — được xem xét nghiêm túc

#183 Opinion · 284 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the role of traditional crafts in preserving heritage.

Weaving, pottery, wood carving and embroidery were once part of everyday life in every region, and in the age of factory production, they are valued for different reasons. This essay will explain two key roles that traditional crafts play in preserving heritage: keeping skills and knowledge alive, and sustaining identity and communities.

First and foremost, traditional crafts keep skills, stories and knowledge alive. Techniques passed from master to apprentice carry knowledge of materials and designs developed over centuries, and much of this cannot be recorded in books. A young weaver who learns patterns from an elder, for example, keeps alive a technique that no book could fully record. Each pattern, shape or colour may have symbolic meaning and tell stories about a community's beliefs, history and environment. When a craft disappears, a whole body of knowledge about local materials, from natural dyes to clay and wood, disappears with it. Museums can preserve objects, but only living practice preserves the skill.

In addition, crafts sustain identity and communities. They give communities a livelihood, particularly in rural areas, attract tourists who wish to buy authentic objects and give craftspeople pride in their heritage. Festivals and markets showcase skills and bring generations together. However, mass-produced goods threaten their survival, since they are cheaper and quicker to make, and young people often prefer better-paid jobs elsewhere. Governments and organisations can help by providing training, fair prices, protection of designs and markets for products, and by teaching crafts in schools. Without such support, many traditions may disappear within a generation.

To sum up, traditional crafts play a vital role in preserving heritage by keeping skills alive and sustaining identity and livelihoods. For these reasons, they deserve support and recognition.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Weaving, pottery, wood carving and embroidery** — dệt, làm gốm, chạm gỗ và thêu
- **traditional crafts** — nghề thủ công truyền thống
- **preserving heritage** — bảo tồn di sản
- **keeping skills and knowledge alive** — giữ cho kỹ năng và tri thức sống mãi
- **sustaining identity and communities** — duy trì bản sắc và cộng đồng
- **Techniques passed from master to apprentice** — kỹ thuật được truyền từ thầy sang học việc
- **materials and designs developed over centuries** — vật liệu và thiết kế phát triển qua nhiều thế kỷ
- **cannot be recorded in books** — không thể ghi lại trong sách
- **learns patterns from an elder** — học hoa văn từ người lớn tuổi
- **symbolic meaning** — ý nghĩa biểu tượng
- **a community's beliefs, history and environment** — niềm tin, lịch sử và môi trường của một cộng đồng
- **natural dyes to clay and wood** — thuốc nhuộm tự nhiên đến đất sét và gỗ
- **only living practice preserves the skill** — chỉ thực hành sống mới giữ được kỹ năng
- **a livelihood** — sinh kế
- **authentic objects** — đồ vật chính gốc
- **pride in their heritage** — tự hào về di sản của họ
- **showcase skills** — trưng bày kỹ năng
- **Mass-produced goods** — hàng hoá sản xuất hàng loạt
- **training, fair prices, protection of designs** — đào tạo, giá công bằng, bảo vệ mẫu thiết kế
- **disappear** — biến mất
- **within a generation** — trong vòng một thế hệ

#236 Opinion · 310 từ · AI 8.0

Discuss how language learning improves cultural understanding.

Learning a second language is often seen as a practical skill for work or travel, but many people also believe that it opens a door to another culture. This essay will explain two key ways in which language learning improves cultural understanding: by revealing other ways of thinking and by allowing direct contact with people and literature.

First and foremost, learning a language gives direct access to another way of thinking and living. Idioms, humour and forms of politeness reveal values that translations lose. A learner who discovers that a polite phrase in another language has no direct translation, for example, begins to see how manners differ between cultures. Vocabulary shows what a society considers important: some languages have many words for family relationships, weather or respect, which says much about daily life. Grammar may reflect different habits of thought, such as how time or social status is expressed. By studying these differences, learners realise that their own language and customs are only one way of seeing the world.

In addition, language learning allows direct contact with people, literature and media. Learners can read novels, poetry and news in the original instead of relying on translation, watch films without subtitles and talk to people in their own words. Making the effort to speak someone's language also earns respect and opens conversations that would otherwise be impossible, which reduces stereotypes and builds friendship. However, language alone does not guarantee understanding. Learners also need to study history, customs and etiquette, and some fluent speakers still hold prejudices. Language study works best when culture is learned alongside grammar, and when it includes contact with native speakers through travel, exchange or online communities.

To sum up, language learning improves cultural understanding by revealing other ways of thinking and by allowing direct contact with people. For these reasons, it deserves a strong place in education.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a second language** — ngôn ngữ thứ hai
- **a practical skill for work or travel** — kỹ năng thực tế cho công việc hoặc du lịch
- **opens a door to another culture** — mở ra cánh cửa vào một nền văn hoá khác
- **language learning improves cultural understanding** — học ngôn ngữ cải thiện hiểu biết văn hoá
- **revealing other ways of thinking** — cho thấy những cách tư duy khác
- **direct contact with people and literature** — tiếp xúc trực tiếp với con người và văn học
- **another way of thinking and living** — một cách nghĩ và sống khác
- **Idioms, humour and forms of politeness** — thành ngữ, hài hước và các dạng lịch sự
- **values that translations lose** — giá trị mà bản dịch đánh mất
- **no direct translation** — không có bản dịch trực tiếp
- **manners differ between cultures** — phép tắc khác nhau giữa các nền văn hoá
- **what a society considers important** — điều một xã hội coi là quan trọng
- **many words for family relationships, weather or respect** — nhiều từ chỉ quan hệ họ hàng, thời tiết hay sự tôn trọng
- **habits of thought** — thói quen tư duy
- **only one way of seeing the world** — chỉ là một cách nhìn thế giới
- **in the original instead of relying on translation** — bản gốc thay vì dựa vào bản dịch
- **watch films without subtitles** — xem phim không phụ đề
- **earns respect** — có được sự tôn trọng
- **reduces stereotypes and builds friendship** — giảm khuôn mẫu và xây dựng tình bạn
- **culture is learned alongside grammar** — văn hoá được học cùng với ngữ pháp

#478 Opinion · 300 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss how cultural festivals support local economies.

Towns and cities across the world host film, food, music and heritage festivals, and many hope that they will benefit local economies. This essay will explain two key ways in which cultural festivals support local economies: through visitor spending and jobs, and through publicity and long-term investment.

First and foremost, cultural festivals bring money, jobs and publicity to the places that host them. Visitors spend on food, accommodation and souvenirs, stalls and performers earn income, and media coverage promotes the area. A potter who sells her work at a festival stall, for example, may earn in a weekend what she usually earns in a month. Festivals often take place outside the main holiday season, which fills hotels and restaurants that would otherwise be empty, and they create temporary jobs in security, catering, transport and cleaning. Local suppliers of food, drink and equipment also benefit, so that money circulates through the community instead of leaving it.

In addition, festivals can generate long-term benefits. A successful event can become part of a town's identity and attract visitors every year, and publicity may encourage investment in hotels, transport and facilities that continue to serve residents afterwards. Some visitors return in other seasons to explore more. However, the benefits are not guaranteed. Organising a festival costs money, much of the work is temporary, and large outside companies may receive most of the income if local businesses are not involved. Crowds and rubbish can also upset residents. Local businesses gain most when residents are involved in organising and supplying the event, and when the programme reflects the character of the place.

To sum up, cultural festivals support local economies by attracting visitors and spending and by building reputation, provided that they are well planned and involve local people. For these reasons, they deserve continued support.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **film, food, music and heritage festivals** — liên hoan phim, ẩm thực, âm nhạc và di sản
- **benefit local economies** — mang lại lợi ích cho kinh tế địa phương
- **cultural festivals support local economies** — lễ hội văn hoá hỗ trợ kinh tế địa phương
- **visitor spending and jobs** — chi tiêu của du khách và việc làm
- **publicity and long-term investment** — quảng bá và đầu tư dài hạn
- **bring money, jobs and publicity** — đem lại tiền, việc làm và quảng bá
- **food, accommodation and souvenirs** — thức ăn, chỗ ở và quà lưu niệm
- **media coverage promotes the area** — truyền thông quảng bá khu vực
- **a festival stall** — một gian hàng lễ hội
- **earn in a weekend what she usually earns in a month** — kiếm trong một cuối tuần bằng thu nhập thường ngày cả tháng
- **outside the main holiday season** — ngoài mùa nghỉ cao điểm
- **fills hotels and restaurants that would otherwise be empty** — lấp đầy khách sạn và nhà hàng lẽ ra trống
- **temporary jobs in security, catering, transport and cleaning** — việc làm tạm thời trong an ninh, ăn uống, giao thông và dọn dẹp
- **money circulates through the community** — tiền luân chuyển trong cộng đồng
- **long-term benefits** — lợi ích dài hạn
- **part of a town's identity** — một phần bản sắc của thị trấn
- **encourage investment** — khuyến khích đầu tư
- **continue to serve residents afterwards** — tiếp tục phục vụ cư dân sau đó
- **return in other seasons** — quay lại vào các mùa khác
- **not guaranteed** — không được đảm bảo
- **temporary** — tạm thời
- **large outside companies** — các công ty lớn bên ngoài
- **upset residents** — làm cư dân khó chịu

- **involved in organising and supplying the event** — tham gia tổ chức và cung ứng cho sự kiện
- **reflects the character of the place** — phản ánh đặc trưng của nơi đó
- **attracting visitors and spending** — thu hút du khách và chi tiêu

Discuss both views

#191 Discuss both views · 262 từ · AI 7.5

Is it better to focus government spending on science or on arts funding? Discuss and give your opinion.

Governments cannot fund everything, and opinions are divided as to whether public money should be spent mainly on science or on arts funding. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of science funding argue that science drives medicine, technology and economic growth. Research produces new treatments, cleaner energy, faster communication and discoveries that improve living standards for everyone. A single breakthrough, such as a vaccine, can save millions of lives and repay its cost many times over. Countries that invest heavily in research tend to have stronger economies and greater security, and young scientists need training, laboratories and long-term support that only governments can provide. Pressing problems, from disease to climate change, can be solved only through scientific knowledge.

On the other hand, supporters of arts funding point out that the arts develop creativity, identity and wellbeing. Museums, theatres and music give people a sense of belonging and meaning, bring communities together and attract visitors, and creative skills are increasingly valued in modern work. An engineer who designs a bridge, for example, needs science to make it strong and art to make it beautiful. Arts and science also support each other, since scientific thinking depends on imagination. Without funding, many cultural institutions would close, and future generations would be culturally poorer.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that science should receive the larger share, because it addresses urgent material needs and drives growth, but the arts deserve a stable and meaningful budget, since a society needs both prosperity and culture.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **cannot fund everything** — không thể tài trợ cho mọi thứ
- **public money** — tiền công
- **science or on arts funding** — khoa học hay tài trợ nghệ thuật
- **supporters of science funding** — người ủng hộ tài trợ khoa học
- **drives medicine, technology and economic growth** — thúc đẩy y học, công nghệ và tăng trưởng kinh tế
- **new treatments, cleaner energy, faster communication** — điều trị mới, năng lượng sạch hơn, liên lạc nhanh hơn
- **improve living standards** — cải thiện mức sống
- **a single breakthrough** — một đột phá duy nhất
- **save millions of lives** — cứu hàng triệu mạng
- **repay its cost many times over** — hoàn vốn nhiều lần
- **invest heavily in research** — đầu tư mạnh vào nghiên cứu
- **training, laboratories and long-term support** — đào tạo, phòng thí nghiệm và hỗ trợ dài hạn
- **only governments can provide** — chỉ chính phủ mới cung cấp được
- **develop creativity, identity and wellbeing** — phát triển sự sáng tạo, bản sắc và sức khoẻ tinh thần
- **a sense of belonging and meaning** — cảm giác thuộc về và ý nghĩa
- **bring communities together** — gắn kết cộng đồng
- **creative skills are increasingly valued** — kỹ năng sáng tạo ngày càng được coi trọng
- **designs a bridge** — thiết kế một cây cầu
- **imagination** — trí tưởng tượng
- **culturally poorer** — nghèo nàn hơn về văn hoá
- **urgent material needs** — nhu cầu vật chất cấp bách
- **a stable and meaningful budget** — ngân sách ổn định và có ý nghĩa
- **prosperity and culture** — thịnh vượng và văn hoá

#238 Discuss both views · 284 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer live concerts while others prefer recorded music. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

A song can be heard in a packed arena or through headphones on a train, and opinions differ on whether people prefer live concerts or recorded music. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of live concerts argue that they offer atmosphere and a shared experience that recordings cannot. At a concert, fans feel the energy of the performance and share emotion with thousands of others, and artists earn directly from ticket sales. A fan who sings along with ten thousand strangers, for example, enjoys a feeling of togetherness that headphones cannot provide. Live music is also unpredictable and authentic, since performers respond to the crowd and may improvise, so that no two shows are the same. Attending a concert creates lasting memories and supports the musicians that people love.

On the other hand, supporters of recorded music emphasise convenience, cost and quality. Recordings can be enjoyed anywhere, at any time, for little money, and the listener can choose from millions of songs and repeat favourite tracks as often as they like. Tickets for major concerts are expensive, crowds are tiring, travel takes time, and sound quality in large venues can be poor. A person with a long commute, for instance, can enjoy a favourite album every day at almost no cost. Recorded music also suits people who are shy, have limited mobility or live far from cities where concerts are held. Studio recordings are carefully produced, so many songs sound better on a recording than live.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I enjoy recorded music for everyday listening, but I regard live concerts as special occasions that offer something recordings cannot match.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a packed arena or through headphones on a train** — đấu trường đông chật hay tai nghe trên tàu
- **live concerts or recorded music** — hoà nhạc trực tiếp hay nhạc thu sẵn
- **atmosphere and a shared experience** — không khí và trải nghiệm chung
- **feel the energy of the performance** — cảm nhận năng lượng buổi biểu diễn
- **share emotion with thousands of others** — chia sẻ cảm xúc với hàng nghìn người khác
- **earn directly from ticket sales** — kiếm trực tiếp từ doanh thu vé
- **sings along with ten thousand strangers** — hát cùng mười nghìn người lạ
- **a feeling of togetherness that headphones cannot provide** — cảm giác đoàn kết mà tai nghe không mang lại
- **unpredictable and authentic** — khó đoán và chân thực
- **respond to the crowd and may improvise** — đáp lại đám đông và có thể ứng tác
- **no two shows are the same** — không có hai buổi nào giống nhau
- **lasting memories** — ký ức lâu dài
- **convenience, cost and quality** — sự tiện lợi, chi phí và chất lượng
- **at any time, for little money** — bất cứ lúc nào, với ít tiền
- **repeat favourite tracks** — nghe lặp lại bài yêu thích
- **Tickets for major concerts are expensive** — vé hoà nhạc lớn đắt đỏ
- **crowds are tiring** — đám đông gây mệt mỏi
- **a long commute** — quãng đường đi làm dài
- **limited mobility** — khả năng di chuyển hạn chế
- **carefully produced** — được sản xuất cẩn thận

#251 Discuss both views · 280 từ · AI 7.5

Is it better to focus government spending on cultural heritage or on new infrastructure? Discuss and give your opinion.

Cities and countries often have to choose between repairing old monuments and building new roads, bridges and railways, and opinions differ on whether public money should be spent on cultural heritage or on new infrastructure. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of heritage argue that it cannot be replaced. Historic buildings, traditions and sites carry the identity of a nation and attract visitors from around the world, and once lost they cannot be rebuilt. A medieval bridge that is allowed to fall into the river, for example, can never be rebuilt, whereas a modern road can be repaired next year. Heritage teaches people about their past, which helps them to understand who they are, and tourism linked to historic sites creates jobs and income for local people. Money spent on conservation is therefore an investment in something that belongs to future generations as well.

On the other hand, supporters of infrastructure point out that it meets daily needs. Roads, water supply, energy, hospitals and public transport affect safety, jobs and living standards immediately, and poor infrastructure can hold back whole regions. A town without reliable roads or clean water, for instance, will find it hard to care about its old buildings. In developing countries especially, basic services must come first, and there is a danger that heritage becomes a luxury when people lack essentials. Good infrastructure also helps tourists to reach heritage sites.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that a balanced budget is wise: urgent infrastructure should receive priority where people lack basic services, while irreplaceable heritage should be protected, as its loss would be permanent.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **repairing old monuments** — sửa chữa di tích cổ
- **new roads, bridges and railways** — đường, cầu và đường sắt mới
- **public money** — tiền công
- **cultural heritage or on new infrastructure** — di sản văn hoá hay hạ tầng mới
- **cannot be replaced** — không thể thay thế
- **carry the identity of a nation** — mang bản sắc của một quốc gia
- **attract visitors from around the world** — thu hút du khách từ khắp thế giới
- **cannot be rebuilt** — không thể xây lại
- **A medieval bridge** — một cây cầu thời trung cổ
- **fall into the river** — đổ xuống sông
- **understand who they are** — hiểu mình là ai
- **creates jobs and income** — tạo việc làm và thu nhập
- **conservation** — bảo tồn
- **belongs to future generations** — thuộc về các thế hệ tương lai
- **meets daily needs** — đáp ứng nhu cầu hằng ngày
- **Roads, water supply, energy, hospitals and public transport** — đường, cấp nước, năng lượng, bệnh viện và giao thông công cộng
- **hold back whole regions** — kìm hãm cả các vùng
- **reliable roads or clean water** — đường xá đáng tin cậy hoặc nước sạch
- **basic services must come first** — dịch vụ cơ bản phải đến trước
- **a balanced budget is wise** — ngân sách cân bằng là khôn ngoan
- **irreplaceable** — không thể thay thế
- **its loss would be permanent** — việc mất nó sẽ là vĩnh viễn

#258 Discuss both views · 284 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer public celebrations while others prefer private family events. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

A wedding or a birthday can be held in a stadium full of strangers or around a kitchen table with a few relatives, and opinions differ on whether people prefer public celebrations or private family events. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of public celebrations argue that they bring communities together and create shared memories. Festivals, parades and national days give thousands of people the chance to enjoy music, food and tradition side by side, and they build a sense of belonging that private events cannot. Public events are usually free or cheap, and they allow people who might not have large families or homes to take part in festive occasions. They also support local businesses and keep cultural customs alive. A fan who sings along with ten thousand strangers, for example, enjoys a feeling of togetherness that headphones cannot provide.

On the other hand, supporters of private family events point out that they are intimate, personal and easier to control. Small gatherings let relatives and close friends talk properly, follow their own customs and spend according to their means, whereas public celebrations are crowded, noisy and expensive for the organisers. A birthday dinner with ten relatives, for example, lets everyone talk and share stories, which is difficult in a crowd of thousands. Private events also suit people who dislike crowds, such as the elderly and families with babies. Family traditions that are repeated privately build strong bonds that last for life.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I enjoy both: public celebrations for the atmosphere and the feeling of belonging to something larger, and private events for close relationships and personal meaning.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a stadium full of strangers** — sân vận động đầy người lạ
- **around a kitchen table** — quanh chiếc bàn bếp
- **public celebrations or private family events** — lễ kỷ niệm công cộng hay sự kiện gia đình riêng
- **bring communities together** — gắn kết cộng đồng
- **create shared memories** — tạo ký ức chung
- **Festivals, parades and national days** — lễ hội, diễu hành và ngày quốc gia
- **music, food and tradition side by side** — âm nhạc, ẩm thực và truyền thống cạnh nhau
- **a sense of belonging that private events cannot** — cảm giác thuộc về mà sự kiện riêng không có được
- **free or cheap** — miễn phí hoặc rẻ
- **large families or homes** — gia đình hoặc nhà ở lớn
- **support local businesses** — hỗ trợ doanh nghiệp địa phương
- **keep cultural customs alive** — giữ cho phong tục văn hoá sống mãi
- **sings along with ten thousand strangers** — hát cùng mười nghìn người lạ
- **a feeling of togetherness that headphones cannot provide** — cảm giác đoàn kết mà tai nghe không mang lại
- **intimate, personal and easier to control** — thân mật, cá nhân và dễ kiểm soát hơn
- **close friends talk properly** — bạn thân trò chuyện đúng nghĩa
- **follow their own customs** — theo phong tục riêng
- **crowded, noisy and expensive for the organisers** — đông đúc, ồn ào và tốn kém cho người tổ chức
- **dislike crowds** — không thích đám đông
- **family traditions** — truyền thống gia đình
- **strong bonds that last for life** — mối gắn kết bền chặt suốt đời

#387 Discuss both views · 288 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that restoring historic buildings is more important than building new structures. Others disagree. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Every city faces a choice between preserving old buildings and replacing them with something new, and some people believe that restoring historic buildings is more important than building new structures. Others disagree. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of restoration argue that old buildings carry memory and identity. Historic buildings tell the story of a community, attract tourists and often have a quality of craftsmanship that is expensive to reproduce. Once demolished, they cannot be replaced, and a city that replaces all its old streets with modern blocks loses its character. Restoration also tends to be more sustainable, since reusing a building saves the energy and materials needed for new construction. An old factory converted into flats and studios, for example, gives new life to a building while keeping the character of the district. Preserving buildings also helps local people to feel proud and connected to their area.

On the other hand, supporters of new building point out that societies have modern needs. Cities need homes, offices, schools and hospitals, and old buildings can be costly to heat, repair and adapt to modern safety standards. In a growing city, refusing to build new structures can raise housing costs and leave people living in poor conditions. New buildings can also be designed to be energy efficient, accessible and attractive, and they will become the heritage of future generations. Rigid protection of every old building can therefore hold a city back.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that important and irreplaceable buildings should be restored, while ordinary ones can be adapted or replaced, and that the best solution is often to reuse historic buildings for modern purposes.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **replacing them with something new** — thay chúng bằng cái mới
- **restoring historic buildings** — phục hồi các toà nhà lịch sử
- **building new structures** — xây dựng công trình mới
- **supporters of restoration** — người ủng hộ phục hồi
- **carry memory and identity** — mang ký ức và bản sắc
- **tell the story of a community** — kể câu chuyện của một cộng đồng
- **a quality of craftsmanship** — chất lượng tay nghề thủ công
- **expensive to reproduce** — tốn kém để tái tạo
- **demolished** — bị phá bỏ
- **cannot be replaced** — không thể thay thế
- **loses its character** — mất đi đặc trưng
- **more sustainable** — bền vững hơn
- **saves the energy and materials needed for new construction** — tiết kiệm năng lượng và vật liệu cần cho xây mới
- **An old factory converted into flats and studios** — nhà máy cũ chuyển thành căn hộ và xưởng
- **gives new life to a building** — đem lại sức sống mới cho một toà nhà
- **feel proud and connected to their area** — cảm thấy tự hào và gắn bó với khu vực của mình
- **modern needs** — nhu cầu hiện đại
- **costly to heat, repair and adapt** — tốn kém để sưởi, sửa và cải tạo
- **modern safety standards** — tiêu chuẩn an toàn hiện đại
- **raise housing costs** — làm tăng chi phí nhà ở
- **irreplaceable** — không thể thay thế
- **reuse historic buildings for modern purposes** — tái sử dụng các toà nhà lịch sử cho mục đích hiện đại

#413 Discuss both views · 274 từ · AI 8.0

Is it better to focus government spending on cultural exchange programs or on infrastructure? Discuss and give your opinion.

Exchange programmes, festivals and cooperation projects between countries involve students, artists and professionals, and opinions differ on whether public money should go to cultural exchange or to infrastructure. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of cultural exchange argue that it builds understanding and brings long-term benefits. Young people who study or work in another country develop language skills, confidence and a wider outlook, and contact between peoples can reduce prejudice and strengthen friendships between nations. A student who spends a year abroad, for example, often returns with contacts that lead to trade, research or partnerships later in life. Cultural links also encourage tourism and trade, and they help a country's reputation. Such programmes are cheap compared with many infrastructure projects, and their effects may last for generations.

On the other hand, supporters of infrastructure point out that it meets urgent needs. Roads, railways, water supply and electricity affect daily life, jobs and growth, and a country that lacks them will struggle to benefit from any exchange. A farmer whose produce rots because there is no road to market, for instance, has more pressing needs than an exchange scholarship. Infrastructure projects also create employment and make a country attractive to investors, while the benefits of cultural programmes are harder to measure. In poor regions, basic services must take priority, because without them people cannot take advantage of educational and cultural opportunities.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Personally, I believe that infrastructure should take priority where basic needs are unmet, but that modest and well-targeted exchange programmes represent excellent value and should not be neglected.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Exchange programmes** — các chương trình trao đổi
- **public money** — tiền công
- **cultural exchange** — giao lưu văn hoá
- **builds understanding** — xây dựng sự thấu hiểu
- **long-term benefits** — lợi ích dài hạn
- **a wider outlook** — tầm nhìn rộng hơn
- **contact between peoples** — tiếp xúc giữa các dân tộc
- **reduce prejudice** — giảm định kiến
- **friendships between nations** — tình bạn giữa các quốc gia
- **spends a year abroad** — dành một năm ở nước ngoài
- **contacts that lead to trade, research or partnerships** — mối quan hệ dẫn đến thương mại, nghiên cứu hoặc hợp tác
- **a country's reputation** — danh tiếng của một quốc gia
- **effects may last for generations** — tác dụng có thể kéo dài qua nhiều thế hệ
- **meets urgent needs** — đáp ứng nhu cầu cấp bách
- **Roads, railways, water supply and electricity** — đường, đường sắt, cấp nước và điện
- **struggle to benefit from any exchange** — khó hưởng lợi từ bất kỳ sự trao đổi nào
- **produce rots** — nông sản bị thối
- **no road to market** — không có đường ra chợ
- **more pressing needs than** — có nhu cầu cấp thiết hơn
- **an exchange scholarship** — học bổng trao đổi
- **attractive to investors** — hấp dẫn nhà đầu tư
- **harder to measure** — khó đo lường hơn
- **take priority** — được ưu tiên
- **basic needs are unmet** — nhu cầu cơ bản chưa được đáp ứng
- **modest and well-targeted** — khiêm tốn và nhắm mục tiêu tốt
- **should not be neglected** — không nên bị bỏ rơi

#473 Discuss both views · 276 từ · AI 8.0

Is it better to focus government spending on arts or on sports development? Discuss and give your opinion.

Governments are regularly asked to fund new galleries, theatres, stadiums and sports programmes, and opinions are divided as to whether public money should go to the arts or to sports development. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of sports development argue that sport improves health and brings communities together. Regular exercise reduces obesity and heart disease, saves health costs and gives young people a positive way to spend their time. Sporting success also creates national pride and provides role models, and major events attract visitors and publicity. A new public swimming pool in a poorer district, for example, can give hundreds of children a place to exercise that their families could not otherwise afford. Sport teaches teamwork, discipline and resilience, and it often draws in young people who are not interested in more traditional cultural activities.

On the other hand, supporters of the arts point out that they develop creativity, cultural identity and mental wellbeing. Museums, theatres and music give people meaning and a sense of belonging, bring communities together and attract tourists. Arts education improves concentration and confidence, and cultural industries create many jobs. Without public support, many cultural activities would disappear, as they cannot survive on commercial income alone, whereas professional sport, with its television rights and sponsors, is often able to fund itself. Culture also records and passes on the stories of a society.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that a balanced budget is best, with sport funding concentrated on community and school facilities that improve public health, and arts funding directed to activities that the market would neglect.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **new galleries, theatres, stadiums and sports programmes** — phòng triển lãm, nhà hát, sân vận động và chương trình thể thao mới
- **public money** — tiền công
- **the arts or to sports development** — nghệ thuật hay phát triển thể thao
- **improves health and brings communities together** — cải thiện sức khoẻ và gắn kết cộng đồng
- **reduces obesity and heart disease** — giảm béo phì và bệnh tim
- **saves health costs** — tiết kiệm chi phí y tế
- **a positive way to spend their time** — cách tích cực để dùng thời gian
- **national pride** — niềm tự hào dân tộc
- **provides role models** — tạo hình mẫu
- **major events attract visitors and publicity** — các sự kiện lớn thu hút du khách và quảng bá
- **a poorer district** — khu nghèo hơn
- **teamwork, discipline and resilience** — làm việc nhóm, kỷ luật và sự bền bỉ
- **draws in young people** — thu hút người trẻ
- **traditional cultural activities** — hoạt động văn hoá truyền thống
- **develop creativity, cultural identity and mental wellbeing** — phát triển sáng tạo, bản sắc văn hoá và sức khoẻ tinh thần
- **meaning and a sense of belonging** — ý nghĩa và cảm giác thuộc về
- **bring communities together** — gắn kết cộng đồng
- **improves concentration and confidence** — cải thiện tập trung và tự tin
- **disappear** — biến mất
- **cannot survive on commercial income alone** — không thể sống chỉ bằng thu nhập thương mại
- **television rights and sponsors** — bản quyền truyền hình và nhà tài trợ
- **fund itself** — tự tài trợ cho mình
- **a balanced budget** — ngân sách cân bằng
- **improve public health** — cải thiện sức khoẻ cộng đồng